Content Performance Review and Renewal SOP - MCN+

Purpose

This document defines how the Programming Committee reviews content performance data to make renewal, promotion, and pull-down decisions across both MCN+ products. It extends the Content Licensing and Catalog SOP's 60-day pre-expiry reminder into an actual data-driven review process, rather than a renewal decided on gut feel alone.

Performance Metrics Reviewed

For every title under review, the Content Performance analyst pulls, by product:

- Watch minutes and viewer count trend over the trailing 90 days.
- Completion rate - the strongest single signal for whether a title is actually holding its audience, not just attracting a first click. A completion rate consistently below 40% is treated as an early warning sign regardless of raw viewer count.
- For licensed titles specifically: engagement relative to license fee already paid (a rough cost-efficiency read, not a formal ROI figure), and the license's remaining term.

Review Cadence

1. Content Performance analyst prepares a performance packet for every title with a license expiring within 90 days, and for every in-house title at its 90-day and 180-day marks post-release.
2. Programming Committee reviews packets monthly, alongside the Content Licensing Manager's calendar of upcoming expirations (per the Content Licensing and Catalog SOP).

Renewal/Pull-Down Decision Criteria

- Renew: completion rate at or above the format's benchmark (streaming series: 50%; Shorts microdrama: 60%, reflecting Shorts' shorter-form viewing pattern) and a stable or growing 90-day viewer trend.
- Renegotiate: performance is borderline (within 10 points of benchmark) - Content Licensing Manager attempts a lower license fee or a shorter renewal term before deciding.
- Pull-down: completion rate more than 15 points below benchmark for 2 consecutive review cycles, with a declining viewer trend - the title is not renewed and follows the Content Licensing and Catalog SOP's retirement notice process.

Underperforming Title Escalation

A newly-released in-house title (not yet eligible for the standard 90-day review) showing a completion rate below 25% in its first 14 days is escalated immediately to the Programming Committee rather than waiting for its scheduled review - this is treated as a signal worth an early editorial/marketing intervention (re-cut trailer, promotional push), not an automatic pull-down.